

Note 7.2 Exponential Change and Separable Differential Equations

Separable Differential Equations

- **Differential Equations**

It has the form

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = f(x, y)$$

where f is a function of both independent and dependent variables.

A **solution** of this equation is a differentiable function $y = y(x)$ defined on the domain of x such that

$$\frac{d}{dx}y(x) = f(x, y(x))$$

on the interval. And the **general solution** is a solution $y(x)$ contains all solutions which always contains an arbitrary constant.

- **Separable Differential Equations**

The differential equation that can be expressed as a product of a function of x and a function of y is **separable**. It has the form

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = g(x)H(y)$$

where g is a function of x and H is a function of y . Then we can rewrite this equation in the form

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{g(x)}{h(y)}$$

where $h(y) = \frac{1}{H(y)}$. That equals to

$$h(y)dy = g(x)dx$$

Now we can simply integrate both sides of this equation,

$$\int h(y) dy = \int g(x) dx$$

Exercise Section 7.2

